



### C64 laptop

No, it's not available for sale, Ben Heck, this is an enthusiast mod rig using original components



### Old news

Prevent laptop theft by using sleeves that look like old newspapers, from Mitemite



### The peewee

Spoil kids silly with the touchscreen laptop for kids, that works like a 21st century slatex

Feature

## ...for home use

### DVD writer

Many notebooks and netbooks come without a built-in DVD writer. Writing a DVD is a necessary task for most people, even when they are on the go. A portable DVD writer is a great option, as these can be used with any kind of computer with a USB drive. There are many small and sleek models available. If possible, pick up a version that plays Blu-ray disks, if not write them. If you burn a lot of DVDs to share with people, or give to clients, it's a good idea to get a LightScribe drive. Such a drive can imprint a black and white pattern on the face of a compatible DVD. The LightScribe variants are only slightly costlier than the regular drives.



### USB speakers

The built-in speakers in most laptops are not adequate for listening to music or playing movies. When it comes to movies particularly, the built-in speakers considerably dampen the experience. Most people connect speakers to the laptop, but these require an additional power supply, and the cabling can be a hassle to manage. USB speakers draw power from the USB port of the computer, and considerably improve the experience of multimedia on laptops. There are a wide variety of USB speakers available, offering variety in design, size, to sound output.

### Wireless mouse

The trackpad is not the best way to navigate through the virtual world. A cabled mouse is good, but a wireless mouse is even better. There are a range of models available in the market, pick up one that is light and fits comfortably in your hand. The lack of wires eliminate clutter, and you don't have to keep going to the back of your laptop to connect or disconnect the mouse. However, most wireless mice use batteries which have to be changed every now and then.



### Portable hard drive

Laptops come with very limited storage capacity. Most people use laptops that have less than 80 GB of storage space. An external hard drive is the solution for this. Although portable hard drives with power supplies are far cheaper than portable hard drives without power supplies, it is a good idea to go for the ones without power supply. These come in handy in the long run, and ensure that the hard drive is as portable as the laptop.



### USB hub

Just like RAM, you can never have enough USB ports. A USB hub partially takes care of this problem. USB hubs are anywhere between two to eight ports attached to one cable. Make sure that the model you pick up are at least USB 2.0, as there are a lot of old hubs in the market. There are also USB "squids" available, which are USB ports with long cables attached to them, this allows for greater mobility.

staggering 70, 000 batteries due to overheating concerns • 20% of all